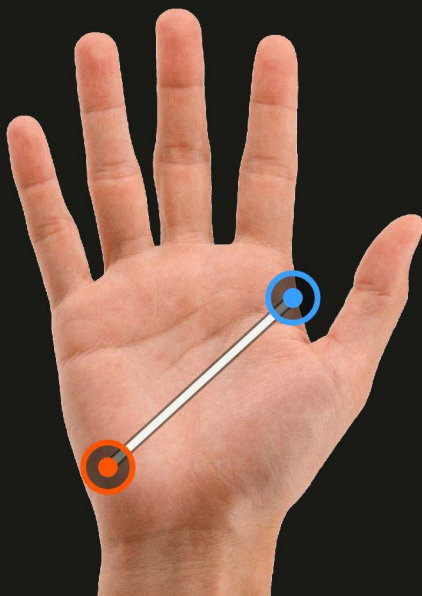


THE PERFECT GRIP

HOW YOUR HAND STEERS TENSION INTO THE TARGET MUSCLE



01 THE TWO CONTACT POINTS



RIGHT INNER PALM

Whether barbell, dumbbell or pull-up bar — the weight **never** lies flat across the palm. It follows the **linea cephalica** — the diagonal palm line — across two precise pressure points at its ends:

A

INNER POINT

In the gap between thumb and index finger, on the linea cephalica.

B

OUTER HEEL OF THE HAND

The pisiform bone (*os pisiforme*) at the lower outer edge of the hand.

This is why dumbbells and D-handles are shaped as a straight line — they fit perfectly into this diagonal angle of your hand.

02 PRESSURE DISTRIBUTION = STEERING WHEEL OF THE SHOULDER

Where you shift the pressure steers the rotation in shoulder, chest and upper back.



BALANCE

50 / 50

Even pressure **centers the joint** and prevents compensations in elbow & shoulder.



EXTERNAL ROTATION

Pressure → outer heel

Promotes external rotation in the joints further up.

Careful: on pressing movements don't let it tip outward — or you lose direct tension on the target muscle.



INTERNAL ROTATION

Pressure → thumb/index

Forces stronger internal rotation.

Used deliberately for **maximum force through the elbow joint** — e.g. on triceps pushdowns.

03 FIRM VS. OPEN GRIP

How hard you grip determines the "distal compression" — and thereby which muscles work *proximally* (closer to the trunk).



FIRM GRIP

▲ HIGH COMPRESSION

Hard fist → more compression. Your **trunk compresses along** and stabilizes.

IDEAL FOR

- **Upper back** — noticeably more activity between the shoulder blades (rhomboids & mid trapezius).



OPEN GRIP

▼ LESS COMPRESSION

Little pressure on the fingers → **favours external rotation**, ribs stay open, no stiffened trunk.

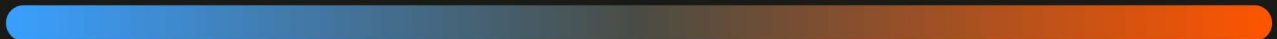
IDEAL FOR

- **Lats** (e.g. cable pulldown) — isolated contraction.
- With **triceps/elbow issues**: an open palm on the attachment prevents compensations into the neck & elbow.

THE COMPRESSION SCALE

OPEN · LESS COMPRESSION

FIRM · MORE COMPRESSION



Lats isolated · trunk free

Trunk stable · back/rhomboids



REMEMBER

Your **hand is the steering wheel**. Grip diagonally across both points, then weight it deliberately: match pressure & grip firmness to the target muscle — don't leave it to chance.

04 WHY BOTH GRIPS WORK

An open grip (external rotation) *and* pressure on the inner palm (internal rotation) both work for the triceps – seemingly a contradiction. The triceps is by nature **compression- and internal-rotation-dominant**. What matters: which **triceps head** you hit and your **body type (bias)**.

INNER PALM

INTERNAL ROTATION

More pressure on the inner palm – between thumb and index finger – strengthens the natural internal rotation and thus the **maximum force through the elbow joint**.

- **Target head:** lateral (outer) & medial (middle) head.
- **Low stability / built "loose"?** The firm grip gives you support so you can build clean tension in the triceps at all.

OPEN GRIP

EXTERNAL ROTATION

The open grip takes pressure out. Important for anyone who is naturally **stiff and tense** – trunk & upper back already tight anyway.

- **Target head:** long head – open grip + shoulder blades slightly forward/up brings it into optimal stretch.
- **No pressure valve:** if the body is too tight, it looks for a valve
→ pain in the neck or elbow instead of stimulus in the muscle. With an open grip the tension stays clean on the triceps.

BOTTOM LINE – WHAT DO I USE WHEN?

INNER PALM, WHEN ...

... you want to move maximum load, hit the **outer head** – or naturally struggle to build stability and tension.

OPEN GRIP, WHEN ...

... you're stiff and tense, often get **neck or elbow pain** on triceps work – or want to isolate the **long head**.